

August 13, 2026

Cigna Healthcare
Cigna Appeals Unit
P.O. Box 188011
Chattanooga, TN 37422

RE: Formal Appeal of Claim Denial — Randall Stroman (MRN MUSC8485581), Claim MUSC-8F43-1

Patient	Randall Stroman (DOB 1956-10-18)
MRN	MUSC8485581
Member ID / Group	CIG204429254 / GRP-30566
Claim number	MUSC-8F43-1
Date of service	2025-12-23
Procedure billed	CPT 99214 — Office/outpatient visit, established patient, moderate complexity
Primary diagnosis	E78.5 — Hyperlipidemia, unspecified
Denied amount	\$407.27
Denial code	CARC 50 / RARC N115 — These are non-covered services because this is not deemed a 'medical necessity' by the payer.
Appeal deadline	2026-07-28

Dear Appeals Review Committee:

SUMMARY OF APPEAL

MUSC Health Florence Medical Center submits this first-level appeal on behalf of patient Randall Stroman (MRN: MUSC8485581, Member ID: CIG204429254, Group: GRP-30566) regarding the denial of Claim MUSC-8F43-1 for a service rendered on December 23, 2025 by Daniel R. Okafor, MD (NPI 1558493021). Cigna Healthcare denied the claim in full on January 29, 2026, citing CARC 50 ("These are non-covered services because this is not deemed a 'medical necessity' by the payer") and RARC N115 ("This decision was based on a Local Coverage Determination (LCD)"), with the accompanying remark that "Documentation submitted does not establish that the service was reasonable and necessary for the diagnosis reported." MUSC Health respectfully disagrees with this determination and requests full reversal and payment at the contracted allowed amount of \$198.25.

CLINICAL BACKGROUND

Mr. Stroman is a 69-year-old male with a well-documented, active chronic disease burden that includes hyperlipidemia (E78.5, active since 2001), anemia (D64.9, active), prediabetes (E11.9, active), rheumatoid arthritis (M17.9, active), and chronic sinusitis (J06.9, active). He is a former smoker and carries a body weight on record of approximately 107 kg. His hyperlipidemia has been actively managed with simvastatin 10 mg, a medication that has been continuously prescribed and monitored across multiple encounters dating back to at least 2011, with the current active order placed on November 17, 2020. The December 23, 2025 encounter was a follow-up visit coded at CPT 99214, an established-patient office visit of moderate complexity, billed at place of service 22 (on-campus outpatient hospital) under revenue code 0510.

BASIS FOR APPEAL

The denial of CPT 99214 for a patient with Mr. Stroman's clinical profile is not supported by the evidence. Hyperlipidemia (E78.5) is a chronic, active condition that has required ongoing pharmacologic management for more than two decades. Periodic evaluation of a patient on long-term statin therapy — particularly one who also carries active diagnoses of prediabetes and anemia, conditions that interact with lipid metabolism and medication tolerability — is consistent with generally accepted standards of care for chronic disease management in an elderly patient. A level-4 established-patient visit (99214) requires and reflects moderate medical decision-making, which is entirely appropriate given the number of active chronic conditions being managed, the ongoing medication regimen, and the patient's age and comorbidity profile.

Cigna's assertion that the documentation does not establish the service as reasonable and necessary does not align with the clinical record. The encounter is a follow-up visit for a condition that has been continuously active and treated. The selection of CPT 99214 is consistent with CPT coding guidelines for established patients whose care involves multiple chronic conditions requiring review, medication management, and clinical judgment. Furthermore, the payer's invocation of an LCD as the basis for denial (RARC N115) requires that Cigna identify the specific coverage criteria the claim fails to meet and demonstrate how the submitted documentation falls short of those criteria. A blanket assertion that necessity was not established is insufficient to sustain a denial when the diagnosis is chronic, active, and long-standing, and the visit type is a routine follow-up consistent with the standard of care.

REQUESTED ACTION

MUSC Health respectfully requests that Cigna Healthcare conduct a full clinical review of the submitted medical record for the December 23, 2025 encounter, reverse the medical necessity denial, and process Claim MUSC-8F43-1 for payment at the contracted allowed amount of \$198.25. Should Cigna require additional clinical documentation to complete this review, we ask that a specific written request be directed to our appeals team promptly so that records may be provided within the applicable timeframe. This appeal is submitted in advance of the July 28, 2026 deadline through the designated portal in accordance with Cigna's appeal submission requirements.

Respectfully submitted,

Angela R. Whitfield, RN, BSN, CPC

Senior Appeals Specialist, Revenue Cycle Management
MUSC Health — Revenue Cycle / Patient Financial Services
(843) 792-2300 | muschealth.org

Enclosures

- Remittance advice / explanation of payment
- Itemized claim detail (UB-04 / CMS-1500)
- Relevant clinical documentation from the medical record